BMAD

Breakthrough Method for Agile AI-Driven Development

A BEGINNER'S GUIDE

SYSTEMATIC CONVERGENCE // 2026 // OPEN SOURCE // MIT LICENSE

What is BMAD?

From chaos to clarity in AI-driven development.

An open-source, multi-agent framework
that structures AI-assisted software development
into a systematic, repeatable process.

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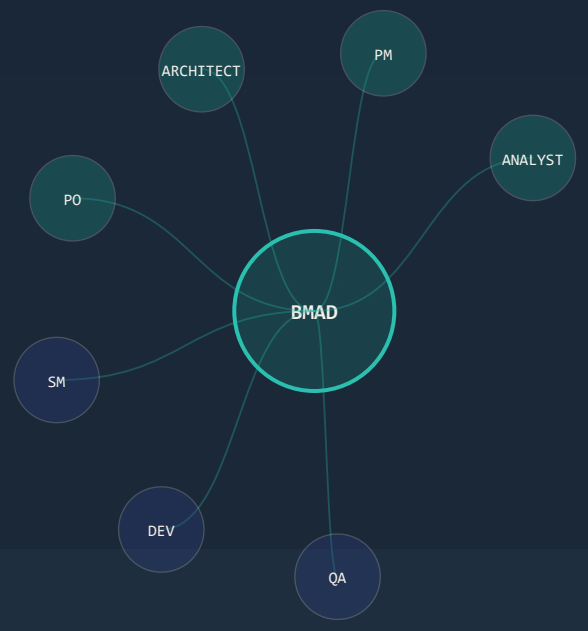

SPECIALIZED AI AGENTS WITH DISTINCT ROLES

3 Core Principles

01

Documentation as Source of Truth

Docs drive everything downstream. Code is a derivative artifact.

02

Agent-as-Code

AI agents defined as version-controlled Markdown files.

03

Structured Handoffs

Explicit artifacts prevent context loss between agents.

The 4 Phases

A SYSTEMATIC CYCLE FROM IDEA TO IMPLEMENTATION

01 Analysis

OUTPUT:

Project Brief

→

02 Planning

OUTPUT:

PRD + Architecture

→

03 Solutioning

OUTPUT:

Alignment + Stories

→

04 Implementation

OUTPUT:

Code + QA

CONTINUOUS CYCLE

The 7 Agent Roles

PLANNING AGENTS

Analyst

Explores idea space, surfaces constraints, produces the project brief.

Product Manager

Turns brief into PRD with requirements, epics, and user stories.

Architect

Designs full-stack system architecture, component maps, and data flow.

Product Owner

Aligns all documents, resolves conflicts, runs the master checklist.

HANDOFF

EXECUTION AGENTS

Scrum Master

Drafts hyper-detailed stories with embedded context and acceptance criteria.

Developer

Implements stories with tests on a branch, guided by control manifest.

QA Agent

Reviews stories, designs test cases, assesses non-functional requirements.

BMAD vs Traditional Agile

Traditional Agile

- Human-only team members
- Source code as truth
- Informal handoffs via meetings
- Documentation is secondary
- Governance added separately
- Scales by hiring people
- Variable consistency

VS

BMAD Method

- AI agents as specialized team members
- Documentation as source of truth
- Structured artifact handoffs
- Documentation is first-class citizen
- Governance built into lifecycle
- Scales instantly with AI agents
- Consistent, predictable behavior

Key Benefits

Eliminates Planning Bottlenecks

AI agents generate PRDs and architecture docs with unprecedented precision.

Cost Optimization

Front-loaded planning concentrates tokens in high-value phases. Create once, reuse.

Built-in Governance & Compliance

Every decision versioned and auditable. SOC 2, HIPAA compliance simplified.

Reduced Context Loss

Structured handoffs with explicit artifacts prevent context evaporation.

Security by Design

Security requirements incorporated from the planning phase, not bolted on.

Scales Instantly

AI agents are always on and scale without hiring or onboarding.

Getting Started

DOCUMENTATION

docs.bmad-method.org

GITHUB

github.com/bmad-code-org/BMAD-METHOD

LICENSE

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The future of development is human + AI collaboration.